



Shopify pending payments and follow-up process.

STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE — CUSTOMER SUCCESS

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1. Purpose

This SOP defines how Customer Success identifies unpaid Shopify orders, decides when to follow up, and coordinates collection with Sales. The goal is to secure the sale, maintain cash flow, and prevent orders from sitting in pending payment long enough that the customer forgets the order or buys the same items elsewhere.

2. Scope

Applies to all Customer Success team members handling Shopify orders for DSS Distro wholesale accounts. Covers pending-payment orders, terms-based orders (7-, 15-, and 30-day), and 1-day terms orders. Verification of the payment terms themselves is out of scope and is handled by SOP-CS-003 (payment-terms order verification).

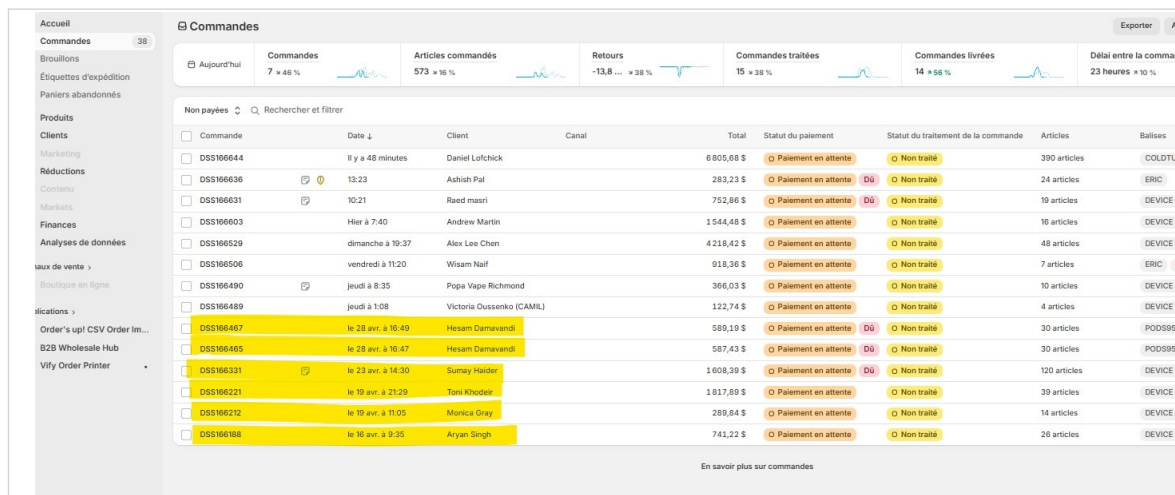
3. Identifying unpaid orders in Shopify

Unpaid orders surface in Shopify through three filters under the Orders view. Together these three lists form the daily follow-up workload for Customer Success.

- **Pending orders** — customers without payment terms. The order is placed but payment has not been received.

- **Terms** — customers on payment terms (7, 15, or 30 days). The order is tagged **terms** until the payment clears.
- **Not paid** — customers on 1-day terms. The order is tagged **not paid** until the payment clears.

The screenshot below shows the Shopify Orders page filtered to **Pending orders**. Highlighted rows are examples of orders that have passed the follow-up threshold and require action.



Commande	Date	Client	Canal	Total	Statut du paiement	Statut du traitement de la commande	Articles	Balises
DSS166644	Il y a 48 minutes	Daniel Lofchick		6 805,68 \$	Paiement en attente	Non traité	390 articles	COLDTUM
DSS166636	13:23	Ashish Pal		283,23 \$	Paiement en attente	Non traité	24 articles	ERIC
DSS166631	10:21	Raed masri		752,86 \$	Paiement en attente	Non traité	19 articles	DEVICE
DSS166603	Hier à 7:40	Andrew Martin		1 544,48 \$	Paiement en attente	Non traité	16 articles	DEVICE
DSS166529	dimanche à 19:37	Alex Leo Chen		4 218,42 \$	Paiement en attente	Non traité	48 articles	DEVICE
DSS166506	vendredi à 11:20	Wisam Naif		918,36 \$	Paiement en attente	Non traité	7 articles	ERIC
DSS166490	jeudi à 8:35	Popa Vape Richmond		366,03 \$	Paiement en attente	Non traité	10 articles	DEVICE
DSS166489	jeudi à 1:08	Victoria Oussenko (CAMIL)		122,74 \$	Paiement en attente	Non traité	4 articles	DEVICE
DSS166467	le 28 avr. à 10:49	Hesam Darnavandi		589,19 \$	Paiement en attente	Non traité	30 articles	PODS95C
DSS166465	le 28 avr. à 10:47	Hesam Darnavandi		587,43 \$	Paiement en attente	Non traité	30 articles	PODS95C
DSS166331	le 23 avr. à 14:30	Sunay Haider		1 608,39 \$	Paiement en attente	Non traité	120 articles	DEVICE
DSS166221	le 19 avr. à 21:29	Toni Khodier		1 617,89 \$	Paiement en attente	Non traité	39 articles	DEVICE
DSS166212	le 19 avr. à 11:05	Monica Gray		289,84 \$	Paiement en attente	Non traité	14 articles	DEVICE
DSS166188	le 16 avr. à 9:35	Aryen Singh		741,22 \$	Paiement en attente	Non traité	26 articles	DEVICE

Figure 1 — Shopify Orders filtered to Pending orders; highlighted rows are overdue follow-ups.

4. When to follow up

Customer Success does not chase every order immediately. Follow-up is triggered by one of the conditions below.

Pending orders (no terms):

- The order has been in pending payment for more than 72 hours.
- The order is high-value.
- Month-end closing is approaching.
- There is a risk of losing the sale.
- Confirm with Sales before reaching out.

Terms / Not paid:

- The agreed term has passed and the order still carries the **terms** or **not paid** tag. Refer to SOP-CS-003 for verification of the term before following up.

Waiting too long has predictable consequences: the customer forgets the order, or buys the same items from another supplier before payment is completed.

5. Special customer handling

Some accounts require a tailored contact approach. Before reaching out, check the Shopify customer profile and ACT notes to confirm both the preferred channel and the correct contact person.

- Some customers are hard to reach by phone but respond reliably to email.
- Some customers ignore email but answer the phone.
- The payment contact is sometimes a different person than the account holder. Do not assume the named contact is the right contact for collections.

6. Daily workflow

Follow-up is fitted around the rest of the Customer Success workload. There is no expectation that every pending order is called the same day it crosses the threshold.

- Follow up on overdue orders during quieter periods of the day.
- Run a full cleanup of the Pending and Terms/Not paid lists during end-of-month closing.
- Prioritise high-value orders and any flagged by Sales over routine pending payments.

7. Coordination with Sales

Duplicate follow-ups damage the customer relationship and waste team time. Always coordinate with the Sales team before contacting a customer about a pending payment. The sales rep may already be working the account.

- Post a short note to the Sales team channel before calling — e.g. **“I’m going to call this customer about a pending payment order.”**
- Wait for acknowledgement from the rep who owns the account before calling.
- If the rep is already handling it, log the handoff and move on.

8. Why follow-up matters

Unfollowed orders create three predictable problems:

- Orders remain stuck in Shopify and never convert to revenue.
- Sales are delayed or lost outright when the customer’s window of intent closes.
- Customers forget their order, leaving the team to absorb the cost of resolution.

Done consistently, follow-up secures the sale, maintains cash flow, and reduces lost orders.

9. Key takeaways

- The Shopify **Pending orders**, **Terms**, and **Not paid** lists are the daily follow-up workload.
- Prioritise high-value and time-sensitive orders.
- Call when email is not effective, and email when phone is not effective.
- Do not let orders stay in pending payment longer than necessary.

Non-Compliance

Failure to follow this SOP results in lost revenue, duplicate customer outreach, and damage to the customer relationship. Specific consequences:

- Orders left unfollowed past 72 hours (co-ordinate with sales) are flagged at the next month-end review and the responsible CS team member is identified.
- Customer outreach made without first checking with Sales is logged as a duplicate-contact incident and reviewed by the CS Lead.
- Repeat incidents are escalated to the Operations Manager and may affect performance review.

Exceptions

Deviations from this SOP are permitted only when the CS Lead approves them in writing (email or Teams message). Permitted grounds:

- Sales has explicitly taken over the account and asked CS to stand down.
- The customer is in a documented dispute or hold status (logged in ACT notes).
- Statutory holidays or system outages prevent normal follow-up. Resume on the next business day.